INTRODUCTION TO URBAN ECOLOGY - FALL 2026

Instructor: Dr. Lena Ortiz Course: BIO 214
Meeting: Tuesday and Thursday, 10:00-11:15

This course studies how plants, animals, and people shape city ecosystems. Read the assigned chapter before each discussion and bring one observation from your neighborhood.

ASSIGNMENTS AND DUE DATES

1. Neighborhood observation journal - September 18, 2026
   Three field observations with photographs and a 500-word reflection.

2. Species profile - October 2, 2026
   Research one urban species and cite four reliable sources in two pages.

3. Midterm data memo - October 23, 2026
   Analyze the class temperature dataset; submit methods and results memo.

4. Team habitat proposal - November 13, 2026
   Propose a habitat improvement with a map, budget, and presentation.

5. Final synthesis essay - December 11, 2026
   Submit a 1,500-word essay connecting two themes to course evidence.

Late work loses 10 percent per day unless an extension is arranged in advance.